

Advanced FEM Techniques (AFEMT)

Lecture 2

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(Conforming) Galerkin method

Consider the slightly more general problem:

$$-d\Delta u = f \quad \text{in } \Omega, \quad u = 0 \quad \text{on } \partial\Omega.$$

with given diffusion coefficient $d = d(x)$.

Let V_h a continuous **piecewise polynomial space** with respect to a **partition (mesh) of the domain**.

Conforming (continuous) FEM: Find $u_h \in V_h$:

$$\int_{\Omega} d(x) \nabla u_h(x) \cdot \nabla v(x) \, dx = \int_{\Omega} f(x) v(x) \, dx \quad \forall v \in V_h.$$

FEM Triplet

A finite element is described by the triplet [Ciarlet, SIAM, 2002]

$$(K, P, \Sigma),$$

where

- ▶ K is the cell,
- ▶ P is the local space of local shape functions (polynomials)

$$\phi : K \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^d,$$

of dimension n_{sh} .

- ▶ $\Sigma = \{\sigma_i\}_{i=1}^{n_{sh}}$ set of unisolvent¹ linear forms (degrees of freedom) acting on P

¹The linear map $\Phi(p) = (\sigma_1(p), \dots, \sigma_{n_{sh}}(p))$ is bijective.

Lagrange elements in deal.ii

Obviously, there exists a basis $\{\phi_j\}_{j=1}^{n_{sh}}$ determined by the property that

$$\sigma_i(\phi_j) = \delta_{ij}.$$

When all σ_i are point evaluations we call this a **Lagrange basis**.

Main FE in deal.II

- ▶ $\hat{K} = [0, 1]^d$
- ▶ $\hat{P} = \mathbb{Q}_k^{(d)} := \text{span}\{x_1^{\beta_1} \cdots x_d^{\beta_d}, \quad 0 \leq \beta_1, \dots, \beta_d \leq k\}$ with basis
 - ▶ $d = 1$: Gauss-Lobatto functions
 - ▶ $d > 1$: tensor product of one-dimensional functions
- ▶ $\hat{\Sigma}$ the corresponding tensor product nodal (Lagrange) basis

deal.II correspondence of concepts

- ▶ mesh cells $\longleftrightarrow$ Triangulation
- ▶ shape functions $\longleftrightarrow$ FEValues, ...
- ▶ degrees of freedom $\longleftrightarrow$ DoFHandler

Mesh in deal.II

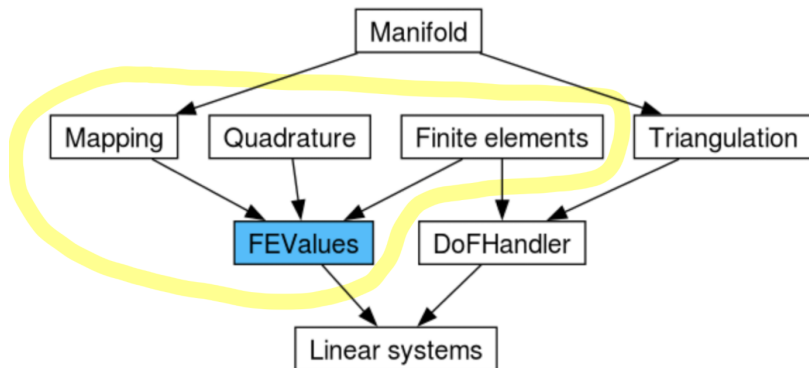
- ▶ Triangulation stores cells, vertices, faces and connectivity.
- ▶ GridGenerator provides standard meshes.
- ▶ Refinement acts directly on the triangulation.

Example

```
Triangulation<2> triangulation;  
GridGenerator::hyper_cube(triangulation, 0.0, 1.0);  
triangulation.refine_global(2);
```

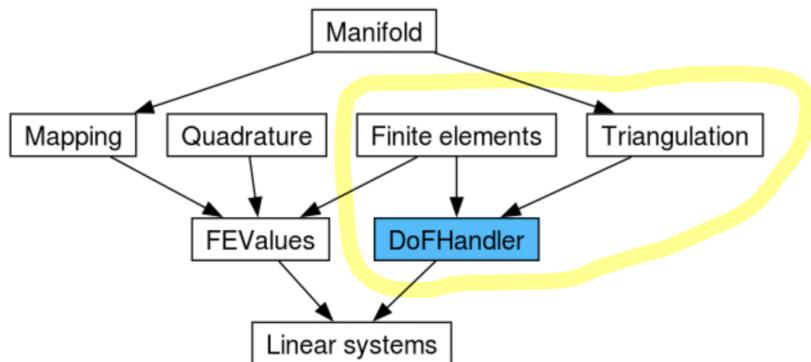
deal.ii architecture: `FiniteElement`, `FEValues`

FiniteElement: abstract base class for FE in any dimension.



FEValues links the `FiniteElement`, quadrature, and mapping classes to produce the required values of the physical element's shape functions

deal.ii architecture: DoFHandler



DoFHandler given a `FiniteElement` and a `Triangulation` enumerates the degrees of freedom.²

Note! the nodes (vertices) of the triangulation are in general different from the degrees of freedom.

²It allows queries of DoF as well as the triangulation data.

Classical Continuous Elements

For conforming methods,

$$V_h \subset H^1(\Omega).$$

A prototype continuous space on a quadrilateral mesh is

$$V_h = \{v_h \in C^0(\Omega) : v_h|_K \circ T_K \in \mathbb{Q}_k(\hat{K}), \forall K \in \mathcal{T}_h\}.$$

Theorem

For $v \in H^1(\mathcal{T}_h)$ we have

$$v \in H^1(\Omega) \quad \Leftrightarrow \quad \text{jump}(v)|_F = 0, \quad \forall F \text{ internal face of } \mathcal{T}_h.$$

Continuity is enforced by identifying interface degrees of freedom.

In deal.ii for, say FE_Q, this is done automatically exploiting the fact that elemental interface values are determined by the interfaces DoF and applying interface constraints. Same for boundary values.

Linear System

Write $u_h = \sum_{j=1}^N U_j \phi_j$. Testing with basis functions gives

$$\sum_{j=1}^N U_j a(\phi_j, \phi_i) = F(\phi_i), \quad i = 1, \dots, N.$$

Hence

$$AU = F, \quad A_{ij} = a(\phi_j, \phi_i), \quad F_i = F(\phi_i).$$

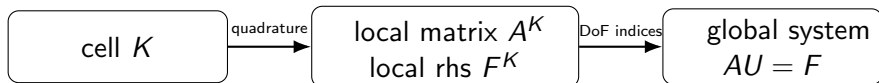
Now, note that

$$A_{ij} = \sum_{K \subset \text{supp}(\phi_i) \cap \text{supp}(\phi_j)} \underbrace{\int_K d(x) \nabla \phi_j(x) \cdot \nabla \phi_i(x) dx}_{A_{ij}^K}$$

DoFHandler

$$A_{ij} = \sum_{K \subset \text{supp}(\phi_i) \cap \text{supp}(\phi_j)} \underbrace{\int_K d(x) \nabla \phi_j(x) \cdot \nabla \phi_i(x) dx}_{A_{ij}^K}$$

Crucial idea: FEM built from local objects + global connectivity.



DoFHandler attaches global indices to local degrees of freedom.

local basis on a cell $\longrightarrow$ global numbering

Bridge between cell-wise calculations and the global linear system.

Assembly

To assemble the stiffness matrix, we need to compute on each element, for $i, j \in \{1, \dots, n_{sh}\}$ terms like

$$\begin{aligned} & \int_K d(x) \nabla \phi_j(x) \cdot \nabla \phi_i(s) dx \\ &= \int_{\hat{K}} d(T_K(\hat{x})) J_K^{-T} \nabla_{\hat{x}} \hat{\phi}_j(\hat{x}) \cdot J_K^{-T} \nabla_{\hat{x}} \hat{\phi}_i(\hat{x}) |\det J_K(\hat{x})| d\hat{x} \\ &\approx \sum_{l=1}^{n_{qp}} d(T_K(\hat{\xi}_l)) J_K^{-T} \nabla_{\hat{x}} \hat{\phi}_j(\hat{\xi}_l) \cdot J_K^{-T} \nabla_{\hat{x}} \hat{\phi}_i(\hat{\xi}_l) |\det J_K(\hat{\xi}_l)| \hat{w}_l \end{aligned}$$

where $\{\hat{\xi}_l, \hat{w}_l\}_{l=1}^{n_{qp}}$ is the set of quadrature points and weights and J_K is the Jacobian of T_K .

- ▶ geometry and ref. shape functions coupled through mapping.
- ▶ choose the quadrature order according to the degree of the integrand (under-integration can destroy accuracy).

FEValues (Core Object)

At quadrature points, FEValues provides

- ▶ values $\phi_i(x_q)$,
- ▶ gradients $\nabla\phi_i(x_q)$,
- ▶ weighted Jacobians $JxW(q)$.

In other words, it turns the abstract bilinear form into something computable.

A priori error analysis

Theorem (Lemma of C  a)

$$|u - u_h|_{1,\Omega} \lesssim \inf_{v \in V_h} |u - v|_{1,\Omega}$$

Theorem (Interpolation error)

Let I_h be the local nodal interpolation operator.

On shape-regular meshes, for sufficiently smooth u ,

$$\|u - I_h u\|_{H^m(K)} \leq Ch_K^{k+1-m} |u|_{H^{k+1}(K)}, \quad 0 \leq m \leq k+1.$$

and, globally,

$$\|u - I_h u\|_{H^1(\Omega)} \leq Ch^k |u|_{H^{k+1}(\Omega)}.$$

$\Rightarrow$ resulting FEM expected to be of order k in energy norm.

Quadrature error

Theorem (Ciarlet, Chapter 4 [Ciarlet, SIAM, 2002])

The order of the FEM is preserved if quadrature is exact on all polynomials of degree $2k - 2$.

In deal.ii, the Gauss–Legendre rules QGauss are used. With n quadrature point, this is exact on $2n - 1$. Hence, in this case, $n = k$ is enough.

We shall use $n = k + 1$. For instance, this guarantees optimality in L^2 -norm also.

deal.II Assembly Code: local-to-global

```
cell->get_dof_indices(local_dof_indices);

for (const unsigned int i : fe_values.dof_indices())
    for (const unsigned int j : fe_values.dof_indices())
        system_matrix.add(local_dof_indices[i],
                           local_dof_indices[j],
                           cell_matrix(i, j));

for (const unsigned int i : fe_values.dof_indices())
    system_rhs(local_dof_indices[i]) += cell_rhs(i);
```

Common Pitfalls

- ▶ confusing nodes with quadrature points,
- ▶ using too low a quadrature order,
- ▶ forgetting that `FEValues` is local while `DoFHandler` is global,
- ▶ ignoring constraints when assembling the global system.